Developer Tools | JavaScript | Web Apps | Open Source

Fetch: a Wget Command Builder

A browser-based builder for GNU Wget commands, covering every option in wget 1.21 with plain-language explanations and warnings for risky choices

Pukar Bhandari 2026-01-25

Table of contents

1 Try it **1**
2 How it works **1**
3 Other ways in **2**
4 Technical details **2**
5 Use cases **3**

GNU Wget can download a file, a folder or a whole website, but only if you remember which of its many switches to combine. **Fetch** lets you build the command visually instead. It covers every option in `wget --help` for version 1.21 (155 settings), explains what each one does, and warns about risky choices. It runs entirely in your browser; nothing is uploaded.

Fetch started as a Wget companion to my Robocopy tool and was redesigned as part of **Conduit**, a pair of command builders that share one design system. Its sister app is Mirror, the Robocopy builder.

1 Try it

Open app GitHub

2 How it works

1. **Pick a starting point.** Choose a preset (One file, Offline site copy, Images only, Check for

broken links, or Gentle crawl) or start from scratch.
2. **Fill in the tabs.** Target, What to download, Save layout, Filters, Performance, Requests, Security, Logging and Advanced. Rarely used options stay hidden until you turn on **Show advanced**.
3. **Watch the command.** It updates as you choose, with every flag explained and notes for risky choices such as skipping certificate checks, putting a password in the command, or crawling with no wait.
4. **Add to queue.** Build several downloads, reorder them, then download one `.bat` or `.ps1` script. Stop on first failure is on by default.

3 Other ways in

- **Find an option.** Type a name or a flag, such as `cookies` or `--limit-rate`, to search every tab at once.
- **Paste a command.** Paste an existing `wget` command and the form fills in. Flags the builder does not recognise are kept under Advanced.
- **Command palette.** `Ctrl+K` jumps to any option, preset or page, and `Ctrl+Enter` adds the current command to the queue.
- **Profiles.** Save a full set of options and load it later. Profiles, the queue and the form are remembered in your browser.

4 Technical details

Fetch is one self-contained `index.html` with no build step to run it and no backend, so your URLs and credentials never leave the browser. It is generated from the shared source in the Mirror repository, so the two apps keep identical design tokens and components. Icons are from Lucide and the fonts are Bricolage Grotesque, Instrument Sans and JetBrains Mono. The code lives in the source repository.

5 Use cases

- **Digital archivists** creating offline mirrors of websites before they go offline
- **Developers** checking a site for broken links
- **Bulk downloaders** working through long lists of files from a list file
- **Students** learning Wget syntax by seeing what each option does

---

Feedback and contributions are welcome! Check out the project on GitHub: https://github.com/ar-puuk/wget-gui